

EZHILAN VENUGOPALAN

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PROFILE

A results-driven, customer-centric leader with 18+ years of global experience delivering end-to-end technology programs across digital transformation, e-commerce, and supply chain domains. Adept at leading large-scale, cross-functional initiatives spanning Enterprise and Digital Technology. Expertise includes Go-to-Market strategy, agile and waterfall delivery, ITSM-based service management, Enterprise Release Management, and Quality Assurance. Domain strengths cover Omni-channel commerce, Order Management, P2P, DTC, and warehouse operations. Skilled in managing full project lifecycles with a focus on governance, compliance, and continuous improvement. Passionate about leading high-impact programs, building resilient teams, and aligning technology with business outcomes. Successfully led global initiatives for clients like Levi Strauss & Co., Dockers, Best Buy, Kohl's, Nike, and RCCL.

SKILLS AND TOOLS

SKILLS: Omni-Channel Commerce- Order capture, sourcing and orchestration, Inventory visibility and availability; Store Commerce and Fulfillment execution; Direct to customer (D2C), Procure to Pay (P2P), Enterprise Release Management, Quality Assurance, Business Analysis and Process Design, IT Service Management (ITSM), Scrum master, Stakeholder Management, Risk Mitigation, vendor management and Cross-Functional Team Leadership

TOOLS: Jira, MS Project, Smartsheet, Confluence, SharePoint, ServiceNow, ALM & TestRail, SAP Solution Manager.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Delivery Manager | LEVIS STRAUSS & CO. | Texas | 2020 TO PRESENT

Led a large-scale global digital transformation initiative (migration of platform) for the Dockers Brand. Led the Go-to-Market (GTM) strategies and successfully launched in new markets also integrated with the marketplace. Led multiple projects, building features and enhancements, and managed change management and application support globally. Agile delivery across global cross-functional teams, managed business stakeholder expectations, vendor relationships, and project governance, ensuring alignment with strategic business goals.

Key Responsibilities:

- Leading the end-to-end delivery of IT initiatives – defining scope, app development, quality Assurance, UAT, release management and application support.
- Lead cross-functional teams consisting of developers (Manhattan Order Management System, AWS, Channel Advisor, Salsify, Manhattan WMS, Mulesoft, SAP PI, QA, Shopify, Narvar, Arvato) vendors, multiple support teams across regions and locations to drive timely and quality delivery.
- Jointly led to the migration of the Dockers brand from Hybris to the Shopify platform.
- Successfully launched in new markets like Sweden, Switzerland, and Spain, and integrated with the marketplace in compliance with business, security, and statutory requirements.

- Implemented a robust incident and problem management process (ITSM), also managed the SLA both internally and the vendor's SLA.
- Owned the Scrum ceremonies and Digital Technology release.
- Budgeting, staffing, effort estimation and resource planning across digital programs.
- Responsible for Vendor Management, Stakeholder Management and liaison between Product Manager, business stakeholder and vendors.

ERP Release Manager | LEVIS STRAUSS & CO. | Texas | 2017 TO 2020

End-to-end management and execution of global Supply Chain IT project releases (SAP ECC and Non-SAP), focusing on planning, integration, and successful deployment of Major and Flex IT initiatives across Levi's enterprise environments. Leveraged a deep understanding of business systems and infrastructure to coordinate the delivery of complex, cross-functional projects with moderate to high risk and impact. My efforts in establishing robust release management processes were recognised with the prestigious **Rivet Award**, a testament to my contributions to operational excellence.

Key Responsibilities:

- Ensured the Release Management strategy and plans are fully integrated with IT governance, project lifecycle checkpoints, and release policies and processes.
- Develop and maintain an 18-month release calendar for Enterprise Technology projects.
- Review, monitor and manage the refresh of environments across the SAP landscapes.
- Communication of release schedule, refreshes, testing timelines and blackout periods to a large audience.
- Understand their requirements and classify the project as Major, Independent or Weekly based on release classification guidelines.
- Create projects in SAP Solution Manager and assign system landscape(s) for the project is SAP ECC, create a charm ID and link the CO to the project.
- Create, consolidate, publish and execute cutover plan for each required rehearsal and production deployment.
- Create daily/weekly cutover status report and publish to all stakeholders.
- Consult with project leads & SMEs to track & mitigate issues/risks, plan coverage and timely execution of tasks.
- Supports the project manager in hyper-care planning, post go-live enhancements and transition to production support.
- Perform checks to validate adherence to the release management and change management process.
- Designed incident and defect dashboards to support IT leadership visibility.

Lead, Global Supply Chain Inbound Applications | LEVIS STRAUSS & CO | Texas | 2015 -2016

- Transitioned and led support for the Global supply chain inbound application (Procure to Pay).
- Maintained and supported the global vendor's application.
- Led project management, enhancements, production support, and continuous improvement initiatives.
- Responsible for building and training team across different locations.

Business Analyst | BEST BUY INC | Minnesota | 2013 –2014

- Contributed to the success of ATHENA, a transformative program dedicated to enabling BBY to engage with its customer data in a whole new way. The program was to develop targeted, relevant, personalized communication for customers. This program was built on the backs of multiple work-streams like Customer Analytics Master (CAM), Customer Identification (CID) and Business Transformation (BTF).
- Led requirements elicitation and management activities, translating stakeholder needs into detailed Business Requirement Documents (BRDs) and user stories to support development and testing efforts, also facilitated daily stand-ups.

Domain Consultant & Scrum Master | KOHLS DEPARTMENT STORES INC | Wisconsin | 2011 -2012

- Led requirement gathering and sprint tracking for ATG re-platform and Loyalty Program projects.
- Enabled customers to earn and manage rewards via a new loyalty platform.

Business Analyst | ROYAL CARIBBEAN CRUISE LTD) | Florida | 2011

- Collected business requirements and defined enhancements for a pricing engine integrated into the reservation system.
- Map and analyze current (as-is) and future (to-be) business processes to identify gaps or opportunities.

Domain Practice, Bid Manager | WIPRO (2007- 2010) | India

- Managed RFP responses and developed client-aligned proposals for clients.
- Business Analysis & Functional Testing: Supported functional testing for Nike's XPDS warehouse management system, focusing on new feature integration to enhance order picking, replenishment, profiling, value-added services (VAS), and packing and shipping processes.
- Supported business advisory services and pre-sales functions.

PREVIOUS WORK HISTORY (2002 – 2007)

- Bharti Airtel Ltd, Marketing Division: (2006 to 2007)
- ITC Limited- India Tobacco Division – Trade Marketing & Distribution: (2002 to 2006)
- VVD Sales Management Services- Marketing Division – Key Accounts (2002 -2002)

EDUCATION QUALIFICATION

- Supply Chain Management, International Academy – IIT Delhi, 2011
- Masters in Retail Consulting: Santa Clara University, Leavey School of Business, 2008
- PG Diploma in Management (Marketing and Systems), INDIA, 2001